

Leadership from Within

Character **First****GOALS MONTH 7**

- You recognize informal leadership in yourself and others without looking at official roles
- You deliberately take a leadership moment at least once a week in training or a match
- You actively invest in the development of a younger or newer teammate

Leadership is not about the captain's armband. Every player can lead at any moment through behavior, attitude, and words. You too.

EXERCISE 1 — WHO DO I FOLLOW?**1 Informal Leaders in Our Team**

Write two teammates you follow, not because they are captain, but because they radiate something. What do they concretely do that has influence?

Person 1 name:

What makes him or her influential?

Person 2 name:

What makes him or her influential?

EXERCISE 2 — MENTOR A YOUNGER PLAYER**2 My Mentor Moment**

Choose a younger player or new teammate. Spend at least 5 minutes with him or her once this month. Write what you wanted to share and how it went.

With whom?

What did I want to share?

How did that person respond?

EXERCISE 3 — THE FIRST VOICE**3 My Leadership Moments**

Write after each training or match: when were you the first voice? When did you take a leadership moment?

"I like pressure. It's a privilege to be in pressure situations."

LeBron James — 4x NBA Champion, Los Angeles Lakers

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SCIENTIFIC FOUNDATION — EVIDENCE PYRAMID

Systematic Review Cotterill & Fransen (2016) — shared leadership correlates more strongly with cohesion and performance than single formal leadership. *Psychology of Sport & Exercise*.

Multi-season Fransen et al. (2020) — teams with 3+ informal leaders perform more consistently than teams with 1 formal leader. *Journal of Sport Sciences*.

Theoretical Côté & Gilbert (2009) — servant leadership significantly increases team trust.

GUIDANCE "THE FIRST VOICE"

- 1 "The First Voice": first constructive voice after a time-out, setback, or before training. Leadership in action.
- 2 Designate a player as "leader of the day." Rotate. Opens warm-up, pre-game speech, or cool-down.
- 3 Evaluate with leader of the day after session: "How did it feel? What will you do differently next time?"

COACH TIPS FOR THIS THEME

Tip 1: Broaden the concept of leader. Always on time, ready for a teammate, never give up = also leadership.

Tip 2: Pair experienced player with newer player. Give them a small shared task.

Tip 3: Name leadership behavior when you see it. "That was leadership."

⚠ Leadership is not always loud and visible. Actively name listening and consistency as leadership behaviors too.

TIMING

- ☐ Introduction shared leadership: 5 minutes
- ☐ Group discussion informal leaders: 10 minutes
- ☐ Planning Leader of the Day: 10 minutes
- ☐ Mentor moment completion: 2 minutes
- ☐ Closing: 3 minutes